

FADEGROOM

A gender-neutral marketplace for hair styling & grooming — booking to payout in one flow.

Prepared for an early investor conversation

Stage Pre-revenue · pre-launch

Status Informational — not a financial promotion

PLEASE READ FIRST — WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS, AND IS NOT

This is an **informational overview** of FadeGroom's product, technology and commercial model. It is **not** a financial promotion, an offer of shares, or an invitation to invest, and has **not** been approved under section 21 of the UK Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (FSMA).

It contains **no valuation** and **no promise of any return**. Every forward-looking figure is labelled as an *assumption* or *illustration* — the founder's to stand behind, not an established fact.

Nothing here is **financial, tax or investment advice**. A prospective investor should take independent professional advice before parting with any money.

Before any fundraising, the regulated elements — instrument, valuation/cap, SEIS/EIS eligibility, and a compliant promotion — must be prepared with a solicitor and accountant (see section 09).

01 — THE COMPANY

What FadeGroom is

FadeGroom is a **gender-neutral marketplace for hair styling & grooming** — connecting customers of all genders with vetted stylists, barbers and grooming professionals ("pros") who deliver either at their own location or by travelling to the customer.

The platform handles the full transaction: discovery, booking, scheduling, in-app payment, and payout to the pro — with the company taking a commission on each completed booking. It exists as a working, built product across:

Two native mobile apps

iOS and Android (Expo / React Native) — customer-facing and pro-facing.

A web application

fadegroom.com — the public product surface.

An admin dashboard

Operations, provider verification, payouts and financial oversight.

A production backend

Laravel / PHP with a live database and Stripe integration.

These are facts about the current codebase, not projections.

02 — THE OPPORTUNITY

The problem & approach

Booking a grooming service is still largely offline — phone-and-walk-in, with no reliable way to discover trusted pros, see real availability, pay securely, or (for the pro) get discovered and paid without chasing cash. FadeGroom digitises that whole loop into a single booking-to-payout flow.

FOUNDER TO COMPLETE

Market-size and demand evidence for your target region belongs here — number of barbers and grooming pros, addressable customer base, any early waitlist or interest. Use real, sourced figures, not round-number guesses. Left for you rather than filled with invented numbers.

03 — THE PRODUCT

What is actually built

This is the core of the honest pitch — the product is not a concept, it is engineered and largely feature-complete for launch:

Full booking engine with a defined lifecycle (request → accept → start/end confirmation → completion), enforced server-side.

Two-sided confirmation of service start and end — neither party can unilaterally mark a job done.

In-app payments via Stripe — saved cards and secure card handling.

Pro payouts via Stripe Connect — pros onboard a connected account and are paid to their bank.

Commission model — the platform's take is applied automatically at payment time and tracked per transaction.

Multi-currency support (USD and GBP).

Provider onboarding & verification — identity documents, portfolio, availability, pricing, with admin review.

Admin dashboard with a permission-gated financial view — a read-only "management / investor" role can be granted visibility without edit rights.

Additional flows — no-show handling, add-on services, gift/recipient bookings, real-time availability, Apple and Google sign-in.

HONEST ENGINEERING STATUS

The platform is under active development. Recent financial-logic corrections (how commission is charged, how platform income is reported) are implemented and awaiting deployment and test verification. There is not yet an automated-test gate or an immutable financial ledger — both are on the near-term roadmap. A serious investor's technical diligence should be welcomed, not managed around.

04 — ECONOMICS

Business model & unit economics

Revenue model: FadeGroom charges a **commission of 17.5%** on each completed booking. The customer pays the full service price; the pro receives the price less commission; the commission is the company's gross revenue.

ILLUSTRATIVE ONLY — NOT A FORECAST

On a £40 booking at 17.5%, gross commission is £7.00. From that, payment-processing fees (charged by Stripe on the *full* £40, not the commission) must be deducted before contribution. This processing drag is proportionally significant on a commission model and **must be modelled precisely** before any margin figure is quoted. The number above illustrates the mechanism — it is not a stated unit margin.

The take-rate model is standard for marketplaces, but the processing-fee-on-gross dynamic is a real margin consideration at this stage. Truthful unit economics — once real transactions exist — will be more persuasive than an optimistic one.

05 — WHERE WE ARE

Current status

Stage	Pre-revenue, pre-commercial-launch. Transactions to date have been test transactions.
Product	Built and substantially feature-complete; final financial-logic verification and launch hardening in progress.
Infrastructure	Live backend, live web presence, apps built and in store-preparation.

This is stated plainly because a pre-revenue stage is a normal and fundable one — but only if described accurately. Investors fund the *next* milestones, not a past that didn't happen.

06 — USE OF FUNDS

Use of an early investment

An early investment would fund the path to launch and first real revenue. Grounded near-term uses include:

- Deploying and verifying the outstanding backend work; standing up an automated test gate and a proper financial ledger for auditable numbers.
- App-store release and launch readiness.
- Initial pro onboarding and customer acquisition in a single beachhead market.
- Professional and compliance costs (legal, accounting, SEIS assurance).

FOUNDER TO COMPLETE

A specific 6–12 month milestone plan with amounts attached to each line, and what a given cheque size unlocks. This is where an investor looks hardest — keep it concrete and defensible.

07 — ROADMAP

Near-term technical roadmap

Because the codebase is well understood, the immediate priorities are concrete rather than aspirational:

01

Deploy & verify

The corrected commission and income-reporting logic.

02

Financial ledger

An append-only record of every money movement (charge, commission, payout, refund), so revenue and take are auditable — and future diligence and accounting are clean.

03

Automated test gate

On the backend, before launch traffic.

04

Launch hardening

Store release, monitoring, support tooling.

08 — THE INSTRUMENT

The shape of an investment — stated honestly

This is the part most commonly misunderstood, so it is stated plainly:

An early-stage investment would be an **equity (or equity-convertible) investment** — most likely a SAFE, an Advance Subscription Agreement, or a small priced round. The instrument is to be set with a solicitor.

There are no dividends. Early-stage startups do not pay income to investors, and this one does not propose to. An investor's potential return comes **only** from the shares being worth more at a future sale or later funding round — an outcome that is **uncertain and may not happen at all**.

Capital is at risk. An investor could lose the entire amount. This is the normal, honest reality of early-stage investing and should be stated directly.

For a UK investor specifically — the real value case (to be confirmed, not yet in place): the standard incentive at this stage is **SEIS** (the Seed Enterprise Investment Scheme), which can offer substantial income-tax relief on qualifying investments, with further reliefs if the company fails.

IMPORTANT HONESTY NOTE

FadeGroom has **not yet obtained SEIS advance assurance from HMRC**, and the founder has not yet taken accounting advice. Until advance assurance is in hand, **SEIS relief must not be presented to any investor as available**. SEIS also requires shares be held for a minimum period and that the company not return value to the investor — a further reason the "dividend" idea does not apply.

09 — PREREQUISITES

Before this becomes a raise

To move from this overview to an actual, lawful investment:

- | | |
|----|--|
| 01 | Engage an accountant (ideally SEIS/EIS-experienced) — to advise on structure and apply for SEIS advance assurance from HMRC. <i>Not yet done; the recommended first step.</i> |
| 02 | Engage a solicitor — to prepare the instrument (SAFE / ASA / share subscription) and set any valuation cap (a pre-revenue company negotiates a cap, it does not assert a valuation). |
| 03 | Ensure any investor-facing promotion is compliant — under FSMA a promotion generally must be issued or approved by an FCA-authorised person, with rules on who may be approached. This overview is informational and is not that promotion. |
| 04 | Produce truthful financials — once the ledger (section 07) is live, real numbers replace assumptions throughout. |

10 — SUMMARY

FadeGroom is a **built, feature-complete hair-styling & grooming marketplace** — real apps, a real backend, live payments and payouts, a working commission model — at a **pre-revenue, pre-launch** stage. Its honest investment case rests on the strength of what is already engineered and a clear, funded path to launch, under a normal early-stage equity structure with no dividends and full capital risk — with UK tax incentives (SEIS) as a likely draw once formally secured.

The numbers that would complete this document — market sizing, milestone costs, and any valuation — are deliberately left to the founder and their advisers, so that everything presented to an investor is something you can stand behind.

This document is informational and was prepared to help the founder organise an honest account of the business. It is not financial, legal or tax advice, and it is not an approved financial promotion. © FadeGroom · fadegroom.com